INCH-POUND
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19 September 1986

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LIFE PRESERVER, INFLATABLE, AIRCREWMAN, CEMENTED TYPE LPU-21C/P AND LPU-23B/P, AND HEAT SEALED TYPE LPU-21D/P AND LPU-23C/P

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for two classes and types of aircrewmen inflatable life preservers.

1.2 Class and type. The inflatable life preservers furnished under this specification shall be one of the following classes and types:

Class 1 Type I - LPU-21C/P - Cemented; with inflation device
Class 1 Type II - LPU-23B/P - Cemented; without inflation device
Class 2 Type I - LPU-21D/P - Heat Sealed; with inflation device
Class 2 Type II - LPU-23C/P - Heat Sealed; without inflation device

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (6.2b).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Wrapping

UU-T-81 - Tags, Shipping and Stock

Beneficial comments, (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commanding Officer, Naval Air Warfare Center Aircraft Division Lakehurst, Systems Requirements Department, Code SR3, Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-T-76	-	Tape, Packaging (For Carton Sealing)

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	-	Preservation, Methods of
MIL-I-23145	-	Inflation Assemblies, Life Preserver
MIL-C-25369	-	Cylinders, Carbon Dioxide for Inflation of Pneumatic Life Preservers
MIL-H-85478	-	Handle, Beaded, Inflation Assembly

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams and Stitching

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-130	-	Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents drawings and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of solicitation.

DRAWINGS

NAVAL AIR SYSTEMS COMMAND

68A73D20	-	Life Preserver Assembly Index, Inflatable, Aircrewman, Type LPU-21C/P
68A73D21	-	Life Preserver Assembly Index, Inflatable, Aircrewman, Type LPU-23B/P

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68A73H1	-	Life Preserver Assembly, Aircrewman, Inflatable, Aramid Cemented, Type LPU-21C/P and Type LPU-23B/P
68A73H6	-	Bladder Assembly, Flotation
975AS200	-	Casing Patterns, Type LPU-21C/P and LPU-23B/P
1957AS100	-	Index for LPU-21D/P and LPU-23C/P Life Preserver
1957AS101	-	Folding Procedure
1957AS102	-	Life Preserver Assembly Type LPU-21D/P
1957AS103	-	Life Preserver Assembly Type LPU-23C/P
1957AS110	-	Bladder Assembly, Flotation Types LPU-21D/P and LPU-23C/P Life Preservers
1957AS191	-	Casing Patterns, Types LPU-21D/P and LPU-23C/P Life Preservers

(Copies of drawings and required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

PUBLICATIONS

NAVAL AIR SYSTEMS COMMAND

NAVAIR 13-1-6.1	Aviation Crew Systems Manual Inflatable Survival Equipment Assembly of

(Copies of Naval Air Systems Command manuals are available from DODSSP - Customer Service Standardization Documents Order Desk 700 Robbins Avenue, Bldg. 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2 Non-Government Publications. The following document forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2.b).

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic, Tariff Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for related associated detail specifications, specification sheet or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. All life preservers furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified products list at the time of award of contract (see 4.3, 4.3.1, 6.5, and 6.9).

3.1.1 Separate qualification listing. Class 1 and Class 2 life preservers require separate qualified products listing. Listing on a particular class can only be accomplished by submission and testing of units made in accordance with the drawing and specification requirements of that class. Listing on the qualified products list in one class includes both type I and type II listing within that class.

3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2f), the life preservers shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.6) in accordance with 4.4.

3.3 Materials and components. The materials and components, except for the metallic parts (excluding the carbon dioxide cylinder), used in the construction of the life preservers shall have been manufactured not earlier than 18 months (see 6.2k and 6.3) prior to the date of delivery of the life preservers.

3.4 Design and construction. The design and construction of the life preservers contained within this specification shall be in accordance with:

Class	Type	NAVAIR Index Designator	Drawing
1	I	LPU-21C/P	68A73D20
1	II	LPU-23B/P	68A73D21
2	I	LPU-21D/P	1957AS100 (sheet 1)
2	II	LPU-23C/P	1957AS100 (sheet 2)

3.4.1 Patterns. The casing for the Class 1 and Class 2 life preservers shall be cut in strict accordance with pattern drawings 975AS200 and 1957AS191, respectively, furnished by the Government (see 6.4). The Government patterns shall not be altered in any manner and shall be used for making the working patterns. The working patterns shall be identical to the Government furnished pattern drawings.

3.4.2 Inflatable compartments. Both Class 1 and Class 2 life preservers shall consist of two independent inflatable compartments in accordance with NAVAIR Drawing No. 68A73H6 and 1957AS110, respectively. Each compartment shall be capable of being inflated mechanically with carbon dioxide and orally through an oral inflation valve and tube. The deflated flotation compartment shall be attached to and contained in a casing, which shall be worn partially around the waist, up the back, and around the neck. Both Class 1 and Class 2 inflatable compartments in their casings shall conform to:

Class	Type	Inflatable Compartment Designator	(Bladder)	Assy
1	I	LPU-21C/P	68A73H6	68A73H1
1	II	LPU-23B/P	68A73H6	68A73H1
2	I	LPU-21D/P	1957AS110	1957AS102 (sheet 1)
2	II	LPU-23C/P	1957AS110	1957AS103 (sheet 2)

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3.5 Bonding methods. The Class 1 life preserver bladder shall be constructed using cemented seams with seam tapes and in accordance with 68A73H6; the Class 2 bladder shall be constructed using heat sealed seams and in accordance with 1957AS110. The Class 2 life preservers shall be constructed using one of the bonding methods (heat sealing principles) set forth in Paragraph 6.9. Thermal bonding shall not be used to join attachments to inflatable components. Adhesive bonding shall be used for this purpose (see 3.5.3).

3.5.1 Cut edges. All the cut edges of the uncoated nylon fibrous materials, except for the base cloths which are to be coated and aramid fabrics, shall be seared prior to the fabrication of the life preserver to prevent fraying. No sharp edges shall be formed.

3.5.2 Surface cleanliness before bonding. Each surface area to be bonded to another surface area shall be cleaned by methyl ethyl ketone (MEK) or other solvent which will remove all surface contaminants, leave no deposits after evaporation, and will not cause loss of adhesion between the base cloth and its coating.

3.5.3 Process requirements - adhesive bonding. In addition to other process requirements not detailed herein, the bonding process shall comply with 3.5.3.1, 3.5.3.2, and 3.5.3.3.

3.5.3.1 Cement composition. Cement composition for Class 1 life preservers shall be of polychloroprene composition suitable for joining polychloroprene-coated nylon fabric; cement for Class 2 life preserver shall be of polyurethane composition suitable for joining polyurethane-coated nylon fabric. The color of the cement shall be natural (unpigmented).

3.5.3.2 Age and condition of cement. Old, partially congealed, or partially polymerized cement shall not be used. Cement containers to be refilled shall be free of such cement prior to refilling. Regardless of age or condition of the batch of cement in use during a work shift, a fresh batch shall be substituted at the start of the next shift.

3.5.3.3 Bonding procedure. Cement shall be deposited in strips parallel to the edges of components to be joined. Deposits shall extend from points near the edges where the deposits are barely visible to points up to one inch beyond the edges. Components while being joined together shall not be under tension. Cemented areas shall not contain trapped air, channels, or excessive wrinkles.

3.5.4 Seams and stitching. Seams and stitching shall conform to these requirements:

a. No stitching shall pass through any inflatable compartment.

b. Sewing shall be used only in construction of accessory parts, not in their final attachment to the life preserver.

c. All machine stitching in the accessory parts shall comply with applicable requirements within drawings.

d. The stitch type shall be stitch type 301, FED-STD-751, eight to ten stitches per inch.

e. Each row of stitching shall be parallel to the seam edge.

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f. The straightness of the stitching in any row shall be maintained within a tolerance of plus or minus 1/32 inch.

g. The ends of the stitching shall be backstitched by overlapping on itself with continuous stitching for not less than 1/2 inch.

h. Thread breaks, skips, and run-offs shall be overstitched not less than one inch. The ends of the overstitching shall be backstitched by overlapping on itself with continual stitching for not less than 1/2 inch.

i. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there not be any loose or tight stitching, and the lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn together.

j. No seam shall be twisted, puckered, or pleated, and no portion of the accessory parts shall be caught in an unrelated seam.

k. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of 1/4 to 3/8 inch.

l. Seam edges shall be properly forced out and shall not contain any folds.

m. No cut end of the tape binding the edges of the casing shall be visible.

3.5.4.1 Bartacking. The number of stitches per bartack shall be based proportionally on a 1/4-inch long bartack containing not less than 14 stitches. The length and location of each bartack shall be as specified in the applicable drawings.

3.6 Warning tag. A red warning tag conforming to UU-T-81, Type B, not smaller than Size 4, shall be strung with twine, and shall be securely tied to the left beltconnecting assembly of each life preserver. The tag shall contain the following information:

WARNING

This life preserver shall not be used until
subjected to the calendar inspection requirements
of NAVAIR 13-1-6.1, Aviation-Crew Systems Manual

3.7 Markings. Markings shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130. The ink, color, size, and locations shall be as specified on the applicable drawings. Letters and numerals 1/4 inch or less in height shall not be stenciled. The markings shall be thoroughly dry prior to packing. The Date of Manufacture and Serial Number may be marked by rubber stamping.

3.7.1 Serial numbers. The preservers shall be identified by individual serial numbers which shall be assigned by the manufacturer. Serialization shall be by a block of consecutive numbers to cover the entire acquisition document quantity.

3.8 Performance inspections.

3.8.1 Weight. When inspected as specified in 4.7.2, the weight of the life preserver assembly shall not exceed 4.0 pounds.

3.8.2 Operation (carbon dioxide).

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3.8.2.1 Unpacked condition. When tested as specified in 4.7.3.1, design shape shall be attained within 30 seconds. There shall be no leakage of carbon dioxide; no hindrance to the flow of the carbon dioxide; or evidence of materials or construction failure in any respect. The seams or attachments shall not pucker when the compartments are inflated or deflated.

3.8.2.2 Packed condition. When tested as specified in 4.7.3.2, the nylon retaining pin safety thread shall break; the nylon retaining pins shall pull out of the retaining loops; the casing shall open fully; and each compartment shall inflate without any restrictions to design shape within 30 seconds. There shall be no leakage of carbon dioxide, no hindrance to the flow of the carbon dioxide, nor evidence of material or constructional failure in any respect. The seams or attachments shall not pucker when the compartments are inflated or deflated.

3.8.3 Buoyancy. When inspected as specified in 4.7.4, the life preserver shall support a 60 pound steel weight without the entire life preserver sinking below the surface of the water. Upon completion of the buoyancy inspection, each compartment shall be completely deflated through the respective oral inflation assemblies. During the deflation, the oral inflation assembly shall be checked for operation without difficulty, restriction of gas flow, positive shut-off and integrity.

3.8.4 Pressure. When inspected as specified in 4.7.5, the pressure in each compartment shall be not less than 4.5 pounds per square inch gage (psig). All the seams, sealed areas, and attachments shall remain perfectly intact and shall show no indication of separation. There shall be no evidence of constructional or material failure in any respect. The seams or attachments shall not pucker when the compartments are inflated or deflated.

3.8.4.1 Fatigue. When inspected as specified in 4.7.5.1, the pressure in each compartment shall hold steady at 3.5 pounds per square inch gage (psig) minimum. All the seams, sealed areas and attachments shall remain perfectly intact and shall show no indication of separation. There shall be no evidence of constructional or material failure in any respect. The seams or attachments shall not pucker when the compartments are inflated or deflated.

3.8.5 Leakage. When inspected as specified in 4.7.6, the pressure in each compartment shall be no less than 1.60 psig. All seams, sealed areas, and attachments shall remain perfectly intact, and shall show no indication of separation. There shall be no evidence of constructional or material failure in any respect. The seams or attachments shall not pucker when the compartments are inflated or deflated.

3.8.6 Burst. When inspected as specified in 4.7.7, each compartment shall rupture at 9.0 psig or higher.

3.9 Workmanship. After completion of the final assembly, the life preservers shall be thoroughly cleaned and all loose thread, lint, and foreign matter shall be removed. The grommets and snap fasteners shall be clinched without distortion, damage, splitting, or cutting of the cloth. The metal components shall not be misaligned nor contain any sharp edge, crack, nick, burr, or silver. The life preserver shall not contain any non-specified hole, abraded area, tear, cut, mend or needle chew. The life preservers shall be uniform in quality and shall be free from irregularities or defects which could adversely affect performance, reliability or durability. The life preservers shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptance criteria specified herein.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspections set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection specified herein are classified as follows:

1. Qualification inspection (see 4.3).
2. First article inspection (see 4.4).
3. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).
4. Quality conformance verification inspection (see 4.5.1.3).

4.3 Qualification inspection. The qualification inspection of both classes of life preservers shall consist of all the examinations and tests specified in table I. The examinations and tests shall be performed in the sequence listed.

4.3.1 Samples. The qualification inspection samples shall consist of three life preservers of the class and type for which qualification has been requested and authorized. For Class 2, Types I and II life preservers, a letter of certification stating the bonding method (heating principles) used (see 6.9) shall be submitted. The qualification samples shall be forwarded as specified in 6.5. The samples shall be plainly identified by securely attached durable tags marked with the following information.

a. Samples for qualification inspection.
b. LIFE PRESERVERS, INFLATABLE, AIRCREWMEN TYPE LPU-(as applicable).
c. Manufacturer's designation or number.
d. Name and address of manufacturer.

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e. Submitted by (name) (date) for qualification inspection in accordance with MIL-L-81561(AS), Class __, Type __ (Applicable Revision Letter, including any Amendment Number under Authorization (reference authorizing letter and number) (see 6.5)).

4.3.2 Retention of Qualified Products Listing (QPL). Retention of qualification listing will be handled separately and independently for each class (see 3.1). The retention of qualification listings shall consist of verification every two years for each class to determine compliance of the listed item with requirements of this specification. Verification shall be by manufacturer's certification unless otherwise specified by the activity responsible for the QPL.

4.4 First article inspection. First article inspection shall consist of all examinations and tests specified in table II. The examinations and test shall be performed in the sequence listed.

4.4.1 First article samples. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, as soon as practicable after award of the contract or purchase order, the manufacturer shall submit three life preservers of the class and type specified in the acquisition document, for first article inspection (see 6.6). The samples shall be representative of the construction, workmanship, components, and materials to be used during production. When a manufacturer is in continuous production of the same life preserver class from contract to contract, submission of further first article samples on a new contract may be waived at the discretion of the acquisition activity (see 6.2f). Approval of the first article samples, or the waiving of the first article inspection, shall not relieve the contractor from complying with all requirements of this specification. The first article samples shall be forwarded as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2g).

4.4.2 First article sample approval. Upon completion of the first article inspection program, recommendations and comments pertinent for use in monitoring production, will be forwarded by the Government Activity responsible for the inspection program (see 6.2g) to the contracting activity. One approved life preserver will be returned to the manufacturer for use in monitoring production. One life preserver will be consumed or destroyed in the first article inspection and shall not be considered as part of the quantity to be delivered under contract. The other life preserver will be retained by the inspection laboratory for reference and will be returned to the manufacturer with the samples from the final production lot.

4.5 Quality conformance Inspection. Sampling plans shall conform to MIL-STD-105 table I. The quality conformance inspection shall consist of the following:

a. Weight of the life preservers

b. Visual examination of the life preservers

c. Operation (carbon dioxide)

d. Pressure

e. Leakage

f. Dimensional check of the life preservers

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g. Packaging

4.5.1 Sampling.

4.5.1.1 Inspection lot.

4.5.1.1.1 Adhesive. For Class 1 only, an inspection lot size shall be expressed in units of one batch of the adhesive. An inspection lot shall consist of all the batches of the adhesive used by the life preserver manufacturer during one day's production of the life preservers (see 3.5.3.2). The sample unit shall be one batch of the adhesive used during one day's production of the life preservers.

4.5.1.1.2 Life preservers. An inspection lot size shall be expressed in units of one life preserver made essentially under the same conditions and from the same materials and components. The sample unit shall be one life preserver.

4.5.1.1.3 Packaging. An inspection lot size shall be expressed in units of one fully prepared shipping container containing life preservers, fully prepared for delivery using essentially the same materials and components. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, containing life preservers, fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed.

4.5.1.2 Sampling for tests and examination of the components and the life preservers and packaging. The sampling size, acceptance criteria, tests, and examinations required for the components, the life preservers, or the packaging shall be as specified in table III.

4.5.1.3 Quality conformance verification inspection. Upon completion of the tests and examinations specified in 4.5.1.2, a random sample shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-3, (see 6.21). The sample size shall be based only on the applicable sample size code letter corresponding to the Inspection Level S-3. Each life preserver selected as a sample unit shall be identified by its assigned serial number (see 3.7.1), and shall be forwarded to the Government Laboratory specified in the procurement document (see 6.2h), for the following tests and examinations (listed sequence mandatory):

TESTS AND EXAMINATIONS

WEIGHT	(4.7.2)
OPERATION (CARBON DIOXIDE)	(4.7.3)
PRESSURE	(4.7.5)
LEAKAGE	(4.7.6)
VISUAL EXAMINATION	(4.7.1.1)
DIMENSIONAL CHECK	(4.7.1.1)

The serial numbers of the unit in the lot, represented by the sample units, shall be furnished to the Government laboratory. The Government activity responsible for conducting the inspection program (see 6.2h) shall report the results of tests and examinations to the designated inspection and acceptance office specified in the procurement documents. Final acceptance of the lot from which the sample units were selected shall be based upon successful completion of the inspection program by the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative/Specialist who shall apply the applicable acceptance criteria specified in table III.

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4.6 Inspection conditions.

4.6.1 Atmospheric conditions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, all inspections required by this specification shall be conducted at a barometric pressure of 28 to 32 inches of mercury and at a temperature of 77 ± 18 degrees Fahrenheit (25 ± 10 degrees Celsius). If the final values of the ambient temperature or barometric pressure at the end of the four-hour air pressure inspection are different from the initial values recorded at the start of the inspection, the following corrections should be made to the final pressure readings in psig.

4.6.1.1 Temperature correction. For each degree Fahrenheit rise in temperature 0.031 psig shall be subtracted from the final pressure reading. For each degree Fahrenheit drop in temperature, 0.031 psig shall be added to the final pressure reading. The corresponding correction per degree Celsius is 0.056 psig.

4.6.1.2 Barometric pressure correction. For each 0.1 inch of mercury rise in barometric pressure, 0.049 psig shall be added to the final temperature-corrected pressure reading. For each 0.1 inch of mercury drop in barometric pressure, 0.049 psig shall be subtracted from the final temperature-corrected pressure reading.

4.6.2 Pressure measurement. The pressure shall be measured by means of a mercury manometer or a low pressure gauge calibrated in tenths psig or fifths inches of mercury. Inches of mercury can be converted to psig by multiplying the inches of mercury by 0.49.

4.6.3 Inspection area and equipment. The area in which the preservers are inspected, shall be adequately protected to preclude damage to the units. The area and inspection equipment shall be free of sharp or rough edges, burrs, protrusions, etc., which will cut, tear or damage the life preserver or the components.

4.6.4 Air. When use of air is specified in an inspection, the air shall not contain any oil or condensed water vapor.

4.7 Inspection methods.

4.7.1 Visual examination.

4.7.1.1 Life preservers. Every life preserver assembly shall be visually examined and dimensionally checked for defects to determine conformance to this specification. The Classification of Defects for Visual Examination (table IV) and List of Defects for Finished Dimensions (table V) shall be used to classify and enumerate the defects found.

4.7.1.2 Packaging. Each of the fully prepared shipping containers, including life preservers, selected as a sample unit from the lot, shall be visually examined to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking conform to this specification. The List of Defects for Packaging (table VI) shall be used to enumerate the defects found.

4.7.2 Weight. The weight of the life preservers including the carbon dioxide filled cylinders, shall be determined on a scale capable of weighing to the nearest 0 - .01 pound, and shall conform to the requirements of 3.8.1.

4.7.3 Operation (carbon dioxide).

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4.7.3.1 Unpacked condition. Unless other wise specified (see 4.7.3.2), the life preserver shall be placed on a table in a flat position with release pins disengaged, as applicable, and hook and pile fastener tapes separated. An inflation assembly conforming to MIL-I-23145, Type II, Style III and a carbon dioxide cylinder conforming to MIL-C-25369, Type III, shall be installed on each compartment for this test. The individual compartments shall be inflated by pulling the beaded handles, for type 1 life preservers, or the inflation lanyards, for type 2 life preservers, to actuate the carbon dioxide cylinders. The preserver shall be observed for conformance to 3.8.2.1. The use of inflation assemblies solely for inspection purposes is prohibited except for type 2 life preservers which are delivered without an inflation system. Test carbon dioxide cylinders (Refilled cylinders) may be used for this test provided they conform to applicable drawings and specification requirements. Additionally, if used, all test cylinders shall be clearly and permanently marked to be readily identifiable as such. Upon completion of this test and examination, the buoyancy inspection (4.7.4), if required, shall be performed while the preserver is inflated with carbon dioxide. Upon completion of this test and inspection (or the buoyancy inspection, if required) the preserver compartments shall be completely deflated in preparation for the pressure inspection (4.7.5). Deflation shall be accomplished through the respective oral inflation assemblies. During the deflation the oral inflation valves shall be depressed and released not less than three times and observed for conformance to 3.8.3.

4.7.3.2 Packed condition. For type 1 life preservers, when performing qualification, first article, quality conformance verification inspections and when required by table III, footnote 5/, the preserver shall be packed within its casing and safety tied in accordance with NAVAIR 13-1-6.1. An inflation assembly conforming to MIL-I-23145, Type II, Style III; a carbon dioxide cylinder conforming to MIL-C-25369, Type III; and a beaded handle assembly conforming to MIL-H-85478 shall be installed on each compartment for this test. The individual compartments shall be inflated by pulling the beaded handles to actuate the carbon dioxide cylinders and the preserver shall be observed for conformance to 3.8.2.2. The use of inflation assemblies solely for inspection purposes is prohibited. Test carbon dioxide cylinders (refilled cylinders) may be used for this test provided they conform to applicable drawing and specification requirements. Additionally, if used, all test cylinders shall be clearly and permanently marked to be readily identifiable as such. Upon completion of this test and examination, the buoyancy inspection (4.7.4) if required, shall be performed or the buoyancy inspection, if required, the preserver compartments shall be completely deflated in preparation for the pressure inspection (see 4.7.5). Deflation shall be accomplished through the respective oral inflation assemblies. During the deflation, the oral inflation valves shall be depressed and released not less than three times and observed for conformance to 3.8.3.

4.7.4 Buoyancy. The buoyancy inspection, when required, shall be conducted in conjunction with the operation (carbon dioxide) inspection while the life preservers are still inflated with the carbon dioxide (see 4.7.3). The inflated life preserver shall be attached to a 60-pound steel weight and placed in clean, fresh water having a temperature of 73 $\pm$ 5 degrees Fahrenheit (23 $\pm$ 3 degrees Centigrade). The preserver shall be inspected for conformance 3.8.3. Upon completion of this inspection, the preserver shall be completely deflated and dried without the application of heat.

4.7.5 Pressure. The carbon dioxide cylinders shall be removed during this inspection. Inflate both compartments with air (see 4.6.4) through the respective oral inflation assemblies to a pressure of 5.0 psig. The air shall be securely

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shut off, and after not less than 10 minutes, the pressure shall be checked and readjusted to the original pressure of 5.0 psig. After not less than 10 minutes after the readjustment period the preserver shall comply with 3.8.4. The life preserver shall then be subjected to the leakage inspection (4.7.6) unless it is subject to qualification or first article inspection, in which case it shall be subjected to the fatigue inspection (4.7.5.1).

4.7.5.1 Fatigue. For qualification and first article, after successful completion of pressure testing per 4.7.5, the life preservers shall be subject to fatigue testing. Inflate both compartments with air through the respective oral inflation assemblies to 4.0 psig, hold there for no more than 15 seconds, and then deflate. Repeat this sequence a total of 4 times, except that on the final sequence, the pressure in the life preserver shall be recorded with 30 $\pm$ 10 seconds after inflation. The final pressure shall comply with 3.4.8.1. The life preserver shall then be subjected to the leakage inspection (4.7.6).

4.7.6 Leakage. The carbon dioxide cylinders shall be removed during this inspection. Inflate both compartments with air (see 4.6.4) through the respective oral inflation assemblies to a pressure of 2.0 psig. The air shall be securely shut off, and after not less than 15 minutes, the pressure checked and, if necessary, readjusted to 2.0 psig. The temperature and pressure shall be recorded at this time. At the end of not less than four hours after the readjustment period, the temperature shall be measured and readjusted for any change in temperature or pressure. The preserver shall meet the requirements of 3.8.5.

4.7.7 Burst. The carbon dioxide cylinders shall be removed during this inspection. Inflate both compartments with air through the respective oral inflation assemblies at a rate of approximately .25 psig per minute until inflation pressure is sufficient to cause failure of material or seams. For each compartment, the pressure at which failure occurs and the type of failure shall be recorded. The pressure readings shall comply with the requirements of 3.8.6.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or Industrial, as specified (see 6.2i).

5.1.1. Level A. Each life preserver shall be packed in accordance with MIL-P-116, Method 1C-2 (modified). Each life preserver cleaned in accordance with process C-1, shall be dusted with zinc stearate or talc, the minimum amount required to prevent the cemented surfaces from adhering to each other in packaged condition. When talc is utilized, it shall be certified by the manufacturer as asbestos-free (see 6.3). Each flotation compartment shall be evacuated of air and each oral inflation valve, in closed condition, shall be tucked in place in the lobe. The life preserver shall be folded in accordance with NAVAIR Drawing No. 68A73H1 for Class 1 life preservers, and NAVAIR Drawing No. 1957AS101 for Class 2. The life preserver shall be completely wrapped in grade A, 35-pound untreated Kraft paper conforming to UU-P-268. Every precaution shall be taken to prevent chafing by hardware or fittings. The wrapped preserver shall be packaged within a snug fitting fiberboard container conforming to PPP-B-636, style CSSC, type CF or SF, weather-resistant class, variety SW, graded W5c or W5s. The body joint and the top and bottom flaps shall be firmly glued together as specified in PPP-B-636, as applicable. The fiberboard container shall not contain; any metal fastening or stitches. All the seams and joints shall be sealed with water-resistant tape, not narrower than two inches wide, and conforming to PPP-T-76.

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5.1.2 Industrial. Each life preserver prepared and folded as specified in 5.1.1 shall be individually packaged to afford the minimum degree of protection necessary to prevent deterioration or damage during shipment under normal environmental conditions and commercial modes of transportation.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B, or Industrial, as specified (see 6.2i). Shipping containers, insofar as possible, shall be uniform in size and shape and of minimum cube and tare weight.

5.2.1 Level A. Six life preservers, packaged as specified in 5.1.1 or 5.1.2 shall be packed as specified in 5.2.2, except that the fiberboard container shall be weather-resistant class, variety SW, grade V3c and V3s. In addition, each container shall be reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Six life preservers packaged as specified in 5.1.1 or 5.1.2 shall be packed edgewise into a close fitting fiberboard container conforming to PPP-B-636, style CSSC, variety SW, grade 275, type: optional. The container body joint and top and bottom flaps, closure thereof shall be accomplished by gluing. The container shall be reinforced (strapped) by two non-metallic bands, applied in accordance with applicable procedures in the appendix to PPP-B-636. No metal staples or stitches are permitted on the container.

5.2.3 Industrial. The packaged life preservers shall be packed within exterior type shipping containers in a manner that will insure safe transportation at the lowest rate to the point of delivery. The container shall be reinforced (strapped) with two non-metallic bands. The shipment shall conform to the minimum requirements of the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation selected (see 2.2).

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, the interior and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and shall include the date of manufacture (month and year).

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory).

6.1 Intended use. The Type I life preservers furnished under this specification are issued to aircrewmen in non-ejection seat aircraft and are worn as delivered. The Type II life preservers furnished under this specification are assembled with a manual/automatic inflation device in the Fleet, and then issued to aircrewmen in ejection-seat aircraft. The life preservers are intended for use as emergency and life support equipment by aircrewmen forced down at sea. This specification does not include the manual/automatic inflation device which must be ordered separately for type 2 life preservers.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification, including any amendments.

b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).

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c. Applicable drawings, including revisions, and class and type to be procured.

d. Government part number, national stock number, and quantity.

e. Applicable qualified products list.

f. Whether first article inspection is waived (see 4.4.1).

g. Name and address of the first article inspection facility (see 4.4.1); and the name and address of the Government activity responsible for conducting the first article inspection program (see 4.4.2).

h. Name and address of the quality conformance verification inspection facility (see 4.5.1.3); and the name and address of the Government activity responsible for conducting the quality conformance verification inspection program (see 4.5.1.3).

i. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

j. Whether any special markings are required (see 5.3).

k. Certificate of compliance for the age of the materials and components (see 3.3 and 6.3), excluding the metallic parts.

l. Selection of quality conformance verification inspection samples to be performed by the cognizant Government quality assurance representative/specialist (see 4.5.1.3).

6.3 Consideration of data requirements. The following data requirements should be considered when this specification is applied on contract. The applicable Data Item Description (DID's) should be reviewed in conjunction with the specified acquisition to ensure that only essential data are requested/provided and that the DID's are tailored to reflect the requirements of the specific acquisition. To ensure correct contractual application of the data requirements, a Contract Data Requirement List (DD Form 1423) must be prepared to obtain the data, except where DOD FAR Supplement 27.475-1 exempts the requirement for DD Form 1423.

Reference Paragraph	DID Number	DID Title	Suggested Tailoring
(a) 3.3, 5.1.1 and 6.2.k	DI-MISC-80678	Certification/ Data Report	10.2.4 only
(b) 4.4.2	DI-NDTI-80809A	Test/Inspection Reports	

The above DID's were those cleared as of the date of this specification. The current use of DID 5010.12-L Acquisition Management Systems and Data Requirements Control List (AMSDL), must be researched to ensure that only current, cleared DID's are cited on the DD Form 1423.

6.4 Patterns. The pattern drawing for the life preserver casing shall be furnished by the contracting officer to the contractor for use in cutting working patterns (see 3.4.1).

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6.5 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are at the time set for opening of bids, qualified for inclusion in the Qualified Products List (QPL-81561) whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of contractors is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or purchase orders for the products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is the Commander, Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, Washington, DC 20360; however, authorization for qualification of products shall be obtained from the Commanding Officer, Naval Air Warfare Center Aircraft Division, Warminster, PA 18974-5000, Attention: Code 6031.

6.5.1 Qualification inspection report. When requested, the manufacturer shall submit an inspection report in accordance with SD6, Provisions Governing Qualification.

6.6 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the items shall be first article samples. The first article shall be as specified in 4.4.1. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first article. Invitation for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.7 Quality conformance. The initial cost of tests and examinations will be borne by the Government. However, the cost of tests and examinations of sample units resubmitted from a reworked lot, or from a new lot which may be necessitated by the rejection of a previous lot, shall be borne by the contractor. Sample units from a rejected lot shall not be resubmitted for tests and examinations without the approval of the contracting officer. Upon completion of testing, the sample units will be returned to the contractor at the contractor's expense.

6.8 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Oral inflation
Carbon dioxide cylinder
Buoyancy
Carbon dioxide inflation
Manual inflation
Flotation system
Thermal bonding
Heat sealing

6.9 Bonding methods (heating principles). The following bonding methods may be applicable in the construction of Class 2 life preservers (see 3.5):

a. Radio frequency

b. Dielectric (electrical resistance)

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c. Electromagnetic induction using a nonmetallic bonding agent.

d. Electromagnetic using a metallic bonding agent.

e. Ultrasonic bonding.

f. Vibration bonding.

g. Fusion bonding.

h. Cement (adhesive) bonding.

Bonding methods should be selected according to the criteria of satisfactory performance at minimum cost. For each class, the method used to qualify the contractor will be the approved production method. The contractor will be required to requalify if his method changes. When heretofore untried methods are applied by a contractor, the acquiring activity should specify a first article submission and inspection, and perform a cost effectiveness evaluation.

Preparing activity
Navy - AS
(Project No. 4220-N391)

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TABLE I. Qualification examinations and tests (see 4.3)

Inspection	Paragraph	
	Requirement	Method
Weight of life preserver	3.8.1	4.7.2
Operation (carbon dioxide)	3.8.2	4.7.3
Buoyancy	3.8.3	4.7.4
Pressure	3.8.4	4.7.5
Fatigue	3.8.4.1	4.7.5.1
Leakage	3.8.5	4.7.6
Visual examination	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1
Dimensional check	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1
Burst	3.8.6	4.7.7

TABLE II. First article examinations and tests (see 4.4)

Inspection	Paragraph	
	Requirement	Method
Weight of life preserver	3.8.1	4.7.2
Operation (carbon dioxide)	3.8.2	4.7.3
Buoyancy	3.8.3	4.7.4
Pressure	3.8.4	4.7.5
Fatigue	3.8.4.1	4.7.5.1
Leakage	3.8.5	4.7.6
Visual examination	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1
Dimensional check	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1
Burst	3.8.6	4.7.7

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TABLE III. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5.1.2)

Inspection 1/	Paragraph		Sample Size	Acceptance Criteria
	Requirement	Method		
Weight	3.8.1	4.7.2	Inspection Level S-3 2/	Acceptable (AQL) quality level of 1.5 2/
Visual examination	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1	a. Every life preserver for critical defects b. Inspection level II for minor defects. 2/	1. Reject all units with any critical defects. 2. Acceptable (AQL) quality level of 15.0 2/
Operation (carbon dioxide) 3/	3.8.2	4.7.3	Every life preserver 5/	Reject all defective units
Pressure 3/, 4/	3.8.4	4.7.5	Every life preserver	Reject all defective units
Leakage 3/	3.8.5	4.7.6	Every life preserver	Reject all defective units
Dimensional check	applicable drawings	4.7.1.1	Inspection Level S-3 2/	Acceptable (AQL) quality level of 10.0 2/
Packaging	Section 5	4.7.1.2	Inspection Level S-2 2/	An acceptable quality level of 2.5 2/

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TABLE III. Quality conformance inspection (con't)

1/ The results of all inspections shall be identifiable by the assigned serial numbers (see 3.7.1).

2/ The sample size and acceptance criteria shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

3/ These inspections shall be performed in sequence. The sequence shall be operation (carbon dioxide), pressure, and leakage. If the Pressure Inspection is performed prior to final assembly (see Footnote 4/), the test may be removed from the sequence.

4/ Pressure inspection may be performed at any time prior to, or after final assembly of the preserver. If performed after final assembly, the sequence outlined in Footnote 3/ shall apply.

5/ One life preserver out of 50, or every fraction thereof shall be inspected in a packed condition (see 4.7.3.2).

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects for visual examination of the life preserver (see 4.7.1.1).

Critical 1/	Minor
1. Any non-specified hole, cut patch or burn.	201. Stitching and sewed seam construction, not as specified. 3/
2. Any fabric damaged, bruised, abraded, containing imperfections, or is otherwise defective. 2/	202. Any spot or stain 3/
3. Any stitching in the inflatable section of the life preserver.	203. Any cut edge of the uncoated nylon nonfibrous material not seared or containing sharp edges.
4. Any grommet missing, mislocated, or improperly clinched. 2/	204. Any snap fastener missing, mislocated, improperly clinched, otherwise defective. 3/ 4/
5. Inflation assembly or manifold stem assembly not in accordance with requirements, not located as specified, or inoperable.	205. Oral inflation assembly or components not specified type; oral valve not locked in the closed position.
6. Any seam separating in the inflatable section.	206. Any actuating lever safety wired to the inflator assembly.
7. Any inflatable section seam construction which does not meet the minimum requirements specified.	207. any metal component improperly finished or containing nicks, burrs, dents, sharp edges or rough surfaces. 3/
8. Any channels or voids in any seam on the inflatable section.	208. Color of any component, not as specified.
9. Inflatable sections and casing assembly not joined, as specified.	209. Any required markings missing illegible, incomplete, incorrect or improperly located.
10. Oral inflation assembly mislocated, bent, distorted or inoperable. Oral tube clamp not installed securely. 2/	210. Any inspection record patch or warning tag missing, illegible incomplete, incorrect, or improperly attached or located.
11. Release pin loop twisted, damaged, or improperly attached not herein classified. 2/	211. Any wrinkles, channels, or voids in any seam, patch or attachment on the inflatable section. 3/

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects for visual examination of the life preserver (see 4.7.1.1). (Con't)

Critical 1/	Minor
12. Any component, component part, or required operation omitted; or any operation improperly performed, not herein classified. 2/	212. Any inflatable section seam construction which exceeds the maximum requirements specified.
13. Any component not as specified, or any defect of a component or assembly not herein classified. 2/	213. Cement on the cloth surfaces around the patches, attachments, seams, seam tapes not visible or in excess of requirements. 3/
	214. any clot or mass of adhesive.
	215. Overlap of any seam tape in excess of requirements.
	216. Any seam tape, patch, or attachment separating. 3/

1/ Any defect shall be classified critical if it appears in the fabric. No more than two or a combination of two contiguous broken or missing picks, tight ends, knots or burrs, or creases are permitted in a 6"X3" area of the finished casing fabric. Baggy, ridgy, wavy and defects which allow light transmission shall be scored as critical in the casing fabric.

2/ The defect shall be classified Critical when it seriously affects serviceability or function; otherwise, it is to be classified Minor.

3/ The defect shall be classified as Minor when it does not seriously affect serviceability or function; otherwise, it is to be classified Critical.

4/ The snap fasteners shall be checked for proper function and attachment.

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TABLE V. List of defects for finished dimensions. (See 4.7.1.1)

Examine	Defect
Measure the life preserver, components, and the casing and components.	Any measurement deviating from the dimensions and tolerances as specified in 3.4 and 3.7, shall be enumerated as a dimensional defect.

TABLE VI. List of defects for packaging. (See 4.7.1.2)

Item	Defect
Exterior and interior markings	Missing, incorrect, incomplete, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application; markings not the same on the interior and exterior containers.
Packaging and packing materials	Any non-conforming component; any component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of the components such as incomplete closure of the unit package, container flaps, loose strappings, etc.; bulging or distortion of the containers; unit container contains metal fastenings or stitches.
Exterior and interior weight or content	Number per container is more or less then required; gross or net weight exceeds the requirements; Item not folded as specified.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-L-81561E(AS)	93/04/21

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

LIFE PRESERVER, INFLATABLE, AIRCREWMAN, CEMENTED TYPE LPU-21C/P and LPU-23B/P

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable) 323-7488	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
COMMANDING OFFICER, NAVAL AIR WARFARE CENTER AIRCRAFT DIVISION LAKEHURST SYSTEMS REQUIREMENTS DEPARTMENT	(1) Commercial (908) 323-7488	(2) AUTOVON 624-7488
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) CODE SR3 LAKEHURST, NJ 08733-5100	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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